

3.1.6 Area of study 4: Western classical tradition since 1910

For the purpose of this specification, western classical tradition since 1910 is defined as music that comprises modern, contemporary classical music, experimental and minimalist music as well as other forms.

Listening – unfamiliar music

Students must be able to listen attentively to unfamiliar music from the following styles/genres to identify and accurately describe musical elements, musical contexts and musical language:

- The orchestral music of Copland
- British music of Arnold, Britten, Maxwell-Davies and Tavener
- The orchestral music of Zoltán Kodály and Béla Bartók
- Minimalist music of John Adams, Steve Reich and Terry Riley.

Study piece

Zoltán Kodály: *Battle and Defeat of Napoleon* and *Intermezzo* from Háry János. (Orchestral version with cimbalom and without vocal parts.)

(first teaching 2020, first assessment 2022, final assessment 2025)

Bartók: *Hungarian Pictures* – the following four movements*:

- *Movement 1: Evening in the Village*
- *Movement 2: The Bear Dance*
- *Movement 4: Slightly Tipsy*
- *Movement 5: Swineherd's Dance*

(first taught 2024, first assessed 2026)

*Please note that *Movement 3: Melody* is **not** to be included.

Musical elements

In addition to the musical elements listed for Area of study 1, students must know and understand musical elements appropriate to this Area of study.

The following table contains all the musical elements, for this area of study, that students must know and understand to answer questions in section A (Listening) and section B (Study piece). Marks will also be awarded for knowledge of other terms if relevant to this area of study in section B (Study piece) of the exam.

Element type	Element
Melody	• ostinato • motifs • melisma.
Harmony	• chromatic • dissonant • pedal.
Tonality	• pentatonic • whole tone • modal • tonal ambiguity.
Sonority (Timbre)	• specific families of instruments • use of technology, synthesised and computer-generated sounds • instrumental techniques eg vamping.
Texture	• drones • imitative • layered/layering.
Tempo, metre and rhythm	• irregular, free • augmentation, diminution • anacrusis • hemiola • rubato • bi-rhythm, cross-rhythm, polyrhythm • syncopation • off-beat.